hold over Firuzkuh. As detailed previously, due to Qutb al-Din's premature death, Firuzkuh was left to his agnatic successors and ultimately inherited by 'Ala' al-Din himself.

In contrast to the abundant information in Juzjani's *Tabaqat* regarding military confrontations and political alliances, the work offers little on Firuzkuh as a settlement or its architecture, such as the population or extent and general location of its buildings. In the seventeenth *tabaqa* on the Shansabani sultans and *malik*s of Ghur, the author mentioned Firuzkuh only infrequently, referring to it as "a fort and a city" without further detail. He does note that after Qutb al-Din's decampment to Ghazna, Baha' al-Din "edified the city and completed the royal buildings and the palace (*qasr*)."[9]

Only an intimation of the ruler's residence and central area of Firuzkuh can be gleaned from *Tabaqat*, and that also from multiple parts spanning several sultans' reigns over approximately sixty years. The majority of the information – meager as it is – comes from the later, imperial phase of the site (cf. also Chapter 4): in the entry on the penultimate Shansabani sultan Ghiyath al-Din Mahmud (r. AH 602–606/1206–1210 CE), Juzjani reported that, during the time of this ruler's more renowned father Sultan Ghiyath al-Din Muhammad (r. AH 558–599/1163–1203 CE), the *qasr* known as Baz Kushk-i Sultan ("the hilltop [called] 'the Sultan's Pavilion/Palace'") was located in the middle of the city. Furthermore,

> … the *qasr* is a building whose equal is not found in any other kingdom or in any capital … in height and area, and with columns (*arkan*), belvederes (*manzar-ha*), galleries (*riwaqat*), and towers/crenellations (*sharfat*) no engineer has created [before]. On top of the *qasr* are five golden turrets (*kungura*), each one three *gaz* and a little over in height, and two *gaz* in circumference; and also two golden *huma*, each the size of a large camel. After the conquest of Ajmer, Sultan-i Ghazi Mu'izz al-Din Muhammad had sent those golden pinnacles and *huma* to Sultan Ghiyath al-Din's capital as a token of his servitude, along with much else of rarity and value, such as a golden ring with a golden chain and two (golden) orbs (*kharbuza*, lit. "watermelon") that were five *gaz* by five *gaz*, and two golden kettle-drums (*kou*) that were brought by cart … Sultan Ghiyath al-Din ordered the ring and chain, and those orbs (*kharbuza*) to be suspended in the monumental entrance portal (*pishtaq*) of the *masjid-i jami'* of Firuzkuh …[10]

From this brief passage, it is apparent that Firuzkuh's *masjid-i jami'* was largely incidental for Juzjani, its entrance merely serving as the stage for display of part of the plunder from Ajmer, which probably reached Firuzkuh *c.* AH 590–591/1194–1195 CE (cf. Volume II). At the same time, even though Juzjani focused more on the Shansabanis' *qasr* or royal palace upon Baz Kushk-i Sultan than any other structure, the palace complex's precise dates of construction remain unclear, as it was already in place